Allons-y!

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By Ben Tupper

A guest is at the helm this week. Ben Tupper has a sailor’s observation about changing course, and a reminder that sometimes the only way forward is to keep moving. Allons-y!



Perhaps by now you have set your rock-filled rucksack down (or did you pick it up?).

It is so good to pause and reflect without weighing, measuring and labeling one’s baggage. Whatever wonders spring forth from a contemplative pause, it’s a bit ironic that we change only by moving forward into our lives.

It is well known among sailors that a boat can only change course when the boat is in motion. You can turn the helm this way and that way without changing course if the boat is still, and the novice sailor might blanch at the sight of ledges ahead in the distance. But, of course, if the boat isn’t moving the ledges are hardly a peril.

It’s so much fun to extrapolate! We can fix a relationship when we are in relationship but not when we are not. We can improve our health only while we are getting older—sorry, you just have to be getting older to be healthier. We learn French when we practice French. Our views get changed by expressing those views to others that don’t share them. We learn something, really learn it, when we teach it. And we think to put down rucksacks after we realize we have been carrying them. Life is so funny, but, please, let’s keep moving.

Happy Thinksday